

The Dutch AI-Receptionist Landscape

Where Klantkraan stands against every rival selling AI answering to Dutch trades — and the two gaps none of them have closed.

Date	Method	Live teardown
2026-07-24	Deep-research + adversarial verification (107 agents, 25 sources)	3 closest rivals, homepages read as a buyer

Bottom line

Klantkraan holds one structurally clean, **unowned position**: it is the only **text-first, trades-vertical, art.50-forward** player in the Dutch market. Every Dutch AI rival is voice/phone-first and treats WhatsApp/SMS as one-way notifications.

The wedge is real but **flanked on headline price**, and the compliance angle stops being a differentiator on **2 Aug 2026**, when art. 50 disclosure becomes mandatory for everyone — so it is a first-mover *message* to bank now, not a durable moat.

The Dutch AI field — your real rivals

Competitor	Model	Pricing	Notes
Voicelabs "Robin" CLOSEST RIVAL	Voice-first, multi-channel	€299 / 500min €599 / 1.000min €899 / 2.000min €0,30/min over	Phone + WhatsApp + webchat + SMS, up to 10 talen. Live callback demo + 7-day trial (no card). EU-hosted, ISO 27001. Markets <i>"klinkt als een collega"</i> — no art.50.
Cowcierge	Voice-first	€149 / 300min €349 / 1.000min €879 / 3.000min	Claims 200+ NL customers (self-reported). Pre-trained op loodgietersbranche. WA/SMS/email post-call only. €349 undercuts your €499 Compleet.
Installatie-Telefoniste Flireo B.V.	Voice-only	€0,25/min geen abonnement setup vanaf €250	Built specifically for installateurs/loodgieters — your exact core vertical. 24/7 spoed-triage, Exact/AFAS, instant browser demo. Dutch-only.

Competitor	Model	Pricing	Notes
VoxFlow	Voice-first inbound	vanaf €99/mo 14-day trial	Same SMB/trades mix. One-way WhatsApp confirmations. <i>"Een gemiste oproep is een gemiste kans."</i>
Watermelon.ai	Text-only, no-code	€0 / 50 conv €99 / 250 €199 / 500 €399 / 1.000	Closest text rival — but horizontal chatbot, not trades. AI pauses when the conversation cap is hit (test messages count) — a real CX weakness to attack.

Traditional human answering services (the incumbent you displace): Telecount €31,50/mo · Pricon €32/mo + €230 setup · Antwoordservice-telefoonservice €9,97/mo + €1,79/call. Cheap on paper, but per-call, human-staffed, not 24/7-scalable. **International** (Synthflow/Vapi/Retell/Bland): only Synthflow overlaps your buyer; their per-minute prices and "no Dutch" claims failed verification — Dutch support is *unverified, not confirmed-absent*.

Live teardown — homepages read as a buyer

Captured 2026-07-24. Interactive demo behaviour (does each bot disclose it's AI when you talk to it, Dutch quality, where it breaks) tested separately.

THE POLISHED ONE

Voicelabs "Robin"

- **Demo bar is high:** live phone (+31) 23 207 70 96, a "Laat Robin mij bellen" callback form, and "Start 7 dagen gratis" (no card). This is the friction level to match.
- **No AI disclosure** — sells the opposite: *"klinkt als een collega, niet als een robot"*, virtuele collega's with names + avatars.
- **Proof gap:** "AI 50+ teams" and its 11 logos are dentists, bowling alleys, a gym, physios — **not one loodgieter or dakdekker**. Markets to trades, proves with leisure/health.

THE ROI-CALCULATOR ONE

Cowcierge

- **Loss-led framing:** leads with "€2.852/maand · €34.000/jaar" misgelopen + a "Bereken je verlies" calculator.
- **Demo** = self-serve free build ("Bouw 'm gratis", "Binnen 15 minuten live"); no live phone/chat demo on the page.
- **No AI disclosure** in sales copy. WhatsApp/SMS are post-call confirmations, **not two-way**.
- **Same proof gap:** testimonials are a dentist, a restaurant, a lawyer — despite claiming loodgieter pre-training.

THE TRADES-NATIVE ONE

InstallatieTelefoniste (Flireo)

- **Highest demo bar:** instant browser demo — *"Gratis · 2 minuten · geen account nodig."* Talk to the bot with zero friction.
- **Sharpest anti-art.50 line found:** *"Klanten merken het verschil vaak niet."* From 2 Aug 2026, that framing is a compliance liability.
- **Weaknesses:** Dutch-only, phone-only, and **zero social proof** — no testimonials, logos, or reviews anywhere.

Two exploitable gaps neither desk research nor the rivals have closed

1 Nobody proves with real trades

Both "trades-focused" rivals prove with dentists, gyms, restaurants and lawyers. **A single real loodgieter/dakdekker case study with night-emergency numbers out-proves all three in your exact vertical** — the strongest argument for the founding-member deal: you're buying proof nobody else has.

2 All three sell "you can't tell it's AI" — you're the compliant mirror image

InstallatieTelefoniste literally sells "*klanten merken het verschil niet.*" Klantkraan's art. 50 disclosure isn't a compromise — after **2 Aug 2026 the disclosing party is the compliant one.** Position it as "*eerlijk tegen jouw klant — en straks verplicht voor iedereen.*"

Interactive funnel test — drove each demo as a buyer

Walked each rival's actual try-it funnel on 2026-07-24 (no accounts created, no forms submitted, no calls placed).

Rival	How you "try" it	Friction	AI disclosed on-screen?
InstallatieTelefoniste	Instant in-browser voice call, no account	Lowest — one click, mic, talk	Yes — widget: " <i>AI-telefoniste demo</i> "
Voicelabs	Callback form (your phone number) / "Bel met Robin" / 7-day trial	Medium — hands over a number or signs up	Yes — " <i>AI-telefoonassistent</i> " throughout
Cowcierge	"Start Gratis" → full signup wall (naam/e-mail/wachtwoord)	Highest — account before you experience anything	Yes — but gated behind signup

The opening this hands Klantkraan

None of the three offers a one-click self-serve **text** demo — they're all voice, so two gate you behind a phone number or a signup. **A one-click, no-account, Dutch text demo you can actually converse with beats all three on friction — the one modality they structurally can't match.** Cowcierge oversells "free" (its "Bouw 'm gratis / live in 15 min" is a signup wall); a genuinely instant demo makes that gap visible.

Two more tells: InstallatieTelefoniste's demo subtitle still reads "*net als een echte patiënt die belt*" — leftover healthcare copy from Flireo's fysiotelefoniste skin, i.e. thinly-adapted templates. And the art.50 fight is **invisible on their websites** — all three label "AI" in their marketing UI; their "*klanten merken het verschil niet*" stance is about what the **end customer hears on the phone**, exactly where art.50 bites from 2 Aug 2026. A prospect never sees it by browsing — so it's a point to make loudly.

Where you win & where you're exposed

✓ Where Klantkraan wins

- **Text-first, two-way WhatsApp** — nobody else owns "never a missed chat"; every rival leads with the phone.
- **Explicit art.50 + AVG/BV posture** — rivals ignore it or market the opposite.
- **Flat tiers** vs Watermelon's service-pausing caps and per-minute voice meters.
- **~90% margin** on the text tier — structurally cheaper to serve than any voice rival.

△ Where you're exposed

- **Headline price** — €99 / €149 / €299 rivals sit at or below you (mostly apples-to-oranges: they're voice).
- **Demo & trial friction** — Voicelabs has a live demo + no-card trial; you must match it.
- **Compliance moat is time-limited** — art.50 becomes table stakes on 2 Aug 2026.

Recommendations

1. **Reframe €299 as "text-first, done-for-you."** Stop losing a headline-number fight you're not actually in. Sell the higher-margin, lower-risk text product as the hero; price or meter voice to protect margin.
2. **Own the anti-voicebot stance.** "Text-first, two-way WhatsApp, we tell your customer it's AI." Lean on art.50 + AVG/BV as a trust headline *now*, while it's still rare.
3. **Match the demo bar and go deeper on the vertical.** One-click Dutch text demo (no form) + explicit no-card trial. Win the loodgieter/dakdekker proof nobody else has.
4. **Pre-empt the voice threat.** Three of four Dutch rivals are voice-native — keep a credible callback/voice upsell so a voice-wanting prospect isn't lost.

Confidence & caveats. Vendor pricing/positioning captured 2026-07-23/24 from live sites and unanimously verified (3-0) against primary sources; SaaS pricing changes often — re-check before any pricing decision. International platforms' per-minute prices and Dutch-support status were *refuted* / *unverified* and are not relied on here. Cowcierge's "200+" is unaudited self-report. Full sources and open questions in `klantkraan/research/competitor-landscape-2026-07.md`.